

Clarification — Same WSI, Different Severity

Acne case walkthrough · why 0.25 read Mild on one visit and Severe on another

NOT A BUG — CONFIRMED BY DESIGN

REF: ACNE DECISION MATRIX, ROW 1

A patient's Progress history showed the same Weighted Severity Index for Acne — **0.25** — on two different visits, but one was labeled **Mild** and the other **Severe**. This note walks through why, using those two actual sessions.

"Why is acne mild for 9 Aug and severe for 31 Jul, although WSI is 0.25 both times?"

The two sessions, side by side

Same WSI. Different decision path.

31 Jul 2026	EARLIER VISIT	9 Aug 2026	LATER VISIT
0.25 WSI		0.25 WSI	
● Severe		● Mild	
WHY SEVERE		WHY MILD	
Lesion type detected: <code>nodules_cysts</code> . The matrix's safety rule fires: nodular/cystic lesions are treated as Severe <i>irrespective of WSI</i> — the 0.25 from count/inflammatory%/redness is overridden outright.		No nodules/cysts detected — override doesn't apply. Decision falls to the normal path: each of the three parameters is banded, and the band two of three agree on wins. Here, that band is Mild.	

The underlying principle

WSI is a measurement. Severity is a decision. They're related, not identical.

WHY THIS IS CORRECT, NOT INCONSISTENT

WSI is the honest, continuous reading from count, density, and redness — useful for trend lines, not a diagnosis on its own. The Mild / Moderate / Severe **decision** comes from a majority vote across those three banded parameters, with clinical safety overrides that can supersede the vote entirely. Nodular/cystic lesions are exactly the case those overrides exist for: raw counts and redness can understate a presentation a clinician would flag on sight, so lesion *type* is allowed to override lesion *count*.

Acne decision matrix, row 1 – "If any lesion is classified as nodule/cyst (or ruptured/bleeding) then consider it as severe irrespective of WSI."

Dermato – WSI Clarification Note

Companion to: Skin Severity Assessment – Parameters & Decision Methodology